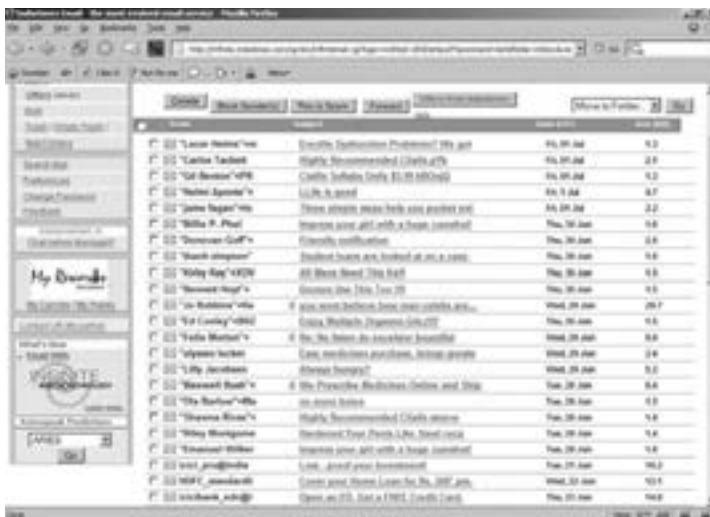


6.1 Spam



Spam Mails Clog The Inbox

Spamming can be defined as “unsolicited and usually commercial e-mail sent to a large number of addresses”. While spam may be defined as indiscriminate mailing, it is almost always associated with commercially-oriented unsolicited mailing. Today, the most common form of spam is e-mail spam. Though the idea of bulk mailing people with commercial pamphlets is not new, the advent of newer means of communication has opened up more vistas for spammers. Spammers have, thus, developed a variety of spamming techniques varying only in the media they operate in. Apart from e-mail spam, they also indulge in instant messaging (IM) spam, search engine spam, spamming a blog with comments, and mobile phone messaging spam.

E-mail spam, though, is the most common form of spamming on the Internet. When e-mail spamming, a spammer sends bulk mails to a large number of recipients. What differentiates legitimate commercial e-mail from spam is the simple fact that spam is